

GigFlow Pro: Requirements Document

Next-Generation Freelance Marketplace v1.0

Comprehensive Web & Mobile Ecosystem Strategy

1. Project Vision

GigFlow Pro is a high-performance freelance marketplace designed to clone and enhance the **Upwork** ecosystem. It facilitates a secure, professional environment where businesses (Clients) and independent professionals (Freelancers) connect, collaborate, and handle payments. The platform emphasizes high-trust matching, time-tracking transparency, and a robust mobile-first communication strategy.

2. Core Functional Requirements

2.1 User Profiles & Verification

- **Dual-Role Accounts:** Users can toggle between 'Client' and 'Freelancer' modes under one login.
- **Verified Badges:** Multi-step identity verification (ID check, video intro, and skill testing).
- **Portfolio Management:** Dynamic grid to showcase work with direct links and case studies.

2.2 The Bidding & Hiring Engine

- **Smart Match:** AI-driven algorithm that suggests jobs to freelancers based on skill-stack and past success.
- **Milestone Management:** Fixed-price project breakdown into funded milestones to ensure payment security (Escrow).

- **Proposals & Interviews:** Real-time bidding system with integrated video calling for interviews.

2.3 Financial & Legal

- **Escrow Protection:** Funds are deposited by the client and held in a secure vault until milestones are approved.
- **Automated Invoicing:** Generation of tax-compliant invoices for every transaction.
- **Dispute Resolution Center:** A structured workflow for mediation if a project goes off-track.

3. Mobile App Specific Features (Companion App)

Real-time Work Diary: A mobile-optimized time tracker that takes randomized screenshots and tracks activity levels for hourly contracts.

- **Instant Messaging:** WhatsApp-style chat interface with file sharing and voice notes.
- **Push Notifications:** Immediate alerts for new job invites, proposal views, and payment receipts.
- **On-the-go Hiring:** Clients can review proposals, check portfolios, and extend offers directly from their phone.

4. User Personas & Experience

Persona	Core Objectives	Key Pain Points
The Specialized Freelancer	Finding high-paying, long-term contracts.	High platform fees and 'race to the bottom' pricing.
The Startup Founder (Client)	Vetting talent quickly to scale a product.	Inconsistent quality and communication barriers.
The Agency Owner	Managing multiple team members on one dashboard.	Difficulty tracking sub-contractor hours and margins.

5. The User Experience (UX) Flow

Flow A: The Talent Acquisition (Client Side)

1. **Post:** Client clicks "Post a Job," chooses between Hourly or Fixed Price, and enters requirements.
2. **Filter:** Uses AI-filters to invite only "Top Rated" freelancers with 90%+ Job Success Scores.
3. **Hire:** Reviews proposals on the mobile app while commuting; clicks "Hire" after a quick video chat.
4. **Approve:** Receives notification that Milestone 1 is complete; reviews work and releases payment with one tap.

Flow B: The Freelancer Success Journey

1. **Prospecting:** Freelancer browses a personalized feed; uses "Connects" to bid on a high-value project.
2. **Contracting:** Receives an offer notification; signs the digital contract and begins work.
3. **Execution:** Uses the Desktop or Mobile Work Diary to log hours and add memos to the work log.

4. **Withdrawal:** Once funds clear the 5-day security period, user withdraws to local bank or PayPal.

6. Security & Trust Architecture

- **End-to-End Encryption:** All messages and shared sensitive files are encrypted.
- **Anti-Fraud Detection:** Monitoring for off-platform payment requests and suspicious login patterns.
- **Reputation System:** Double-blind feedback system (users only see their rating after they have left their own).